CHAPTER 8

Integration Testing with Capybara and Cucumber

You spent the last few chapters focusing on testing the models and business logic of your Rails application. A web application is more than just business logic, though, so for the next few chapters, I'm going to talk about tests that tackle the parts of your application that either respond to user input or output data to the user.

There's a lot of different terminology used to describe the various flavors of input and output tests you can write. First, there are generic terms that are not inherent to Rails, but are terms you might apply to any kind of testing:

- An *integration* test is any test that covers more than one part of the application working together.
- An *end-to-end* test is a specific kind of integration test that covers the entire behavior of the system from, well, end to end.
- An *acceptance* test is written to specify correct behavior from the customer or business perspective. Acceptance tests are often written (or at least planned) before coding even begins.

Within Rails-land, there is a significant functional distinction between integration tests that only use Rails and evaluate the results of a Rails call, and those that also use a JavaScript driver to evaluate JavaScript based on simulated user actions. In this chapter you'll see the non-JavaScript versions; in the next, you'll learn how to add JavaScript client behavior.